

# Listening into Writing

## Demographics



THE LONDON SCHOOL  
OF ECONOMICS AND  
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

- You are going to hear a TED talk called “The truth about human population decline”.
- The talk was given by political demographer Jennifer D. Sciubba.
- This talk is shorter than usual at approximately 10 minutes long.



# Task



As in previous weeks:

- Listen to the talk and take notes.
- Use your notes to write a summary of 200-400 words.
- You have 40-minutes to write the summary using your notes.

# Listen & take notes



# Check List



1. Do you have an opening sentence which identifies the topic of the talk?
2. Do you have a concluding sentence which 'wraps up' the summary e.g. by restating the main point of the talk?
3. Do you use a range of linking expressions & cohesive devices to connect sentences and ideas?
4. Do you use a range of reporting expressions to report what the speaker said?
5. Do you have some critical evaluation? (Consider applying the CRAAP test – see next slide)

# The CRAAP Test



The CRAAP test is a method to evaluate the credibility of a source. It has 5 main components

1. **Currency:** Is the evidence recent? Are statistics or studies up to date?
2. **Relevance:** Does the evidence directly support the speaker's argument?
3. **Authority:** Who is the speaker? Are they considered reputable and trustworthy in their field?
4. **Accuracy:** Is there enough evidence for the speaker's claims? Is the evidence reliable or mainly anecdotal?
5. **Purpose:** Is the speaker trying to inform, persuade, or advocate? Could this shape how evidence is presented?

# Sample Summary



Look at the sample summary on Moodle.

- a) Highlight the opening sentence. Is it effective? Why/Why not?
- b) Highlight the concluding sentence. Is it effective? Why/Why not?
- c) Highlight reporting expressions.
- d) Highlight linking expressions.
- e) Highlight critical language.
- f) Overall, do you think it is an effective summary? Why/Why not?